Federal Popular Initiative
“For the Digital Security of Switzerland”

1. Introduction – What Is It About?

In December 2025, the Federal Chancellery was contacted regarding the launch of a federal popular initiative entitled “For the Digital Security of Switzerland”. The initiative proposes the introduction of a new article into the Federal Constitution, granting the Confederation the authority to ensure Switzerland’s digital security and digital sovereignty.

The initiative seeks to protect critical digital infrastructure, government information systems, data essential to the functioning of the country, and the digital integrity of citizens. It does not regulate specific technologies. Instead, it establishes a durable constitutional framework that allows Switzerland to address digital challenges with stability, continuity, and full sovereign authority.

2. Why a Popular Initiative on Digital Security?

National Context

Switzerland and its population rely extensively on digital systems for the functioning of the state, the economy, and society as a whole: public administration, healthcare, transport, finance, energy, communications, and democratic processes. Any major disruption or hostile exploitation of these systems may have immediate and systemic consequences.

While Switzerland already has advanced policies in cybersecurity, data protection, and digital transformation, the Confederation must have a clear constitutional basis enabling it to fully exercise its responsibilities in matters of digital security and national sovereignty.

International Context

Cyber threats are increasing worldwide: attacks on critical infrastructure, digital espionage, technological dependencies, and growing geopolitical pressure. Many states are strengthening their digital sovereignty and clarifying institutional responsibilities in this domain.

In this context, the initiative aims to provide Switzerland with a clear constitutional foundation, allowing it to remain autonomous, resilient, and credible in the digital space, without resorting to isolation, excessive control, or confrontation.

3. What Is the Concrete Impact of the Initiative?

For the Confederation

The initiative:
- enables the Confederation to assume its responsibilities in digital security
- strengthens coordination between federal and cantonal authorities
- provides a stable constitutional foundation for existing and future public policies, reflecting the rapid evolution of digital technologies

It does not create new authorities or impose new regulatory obligations, but establishes a durable reference framework.

For the Population and Economic Actors

For citizens and businesses, the initiative:
- strengthens the protection of personal data and digital integrity
- supports the continuity of essential services
- improves legal and institutional predictability
- encourages the development of digital skills across society

4. Why Is a Constitutional Basis Important?

Unlike sector-specific legislation or government strategies, the Constitution:
- defines long-term responsibilities, independent of political cycles
- provides a high level of legal certainty
- enables coherent coordination across policy areas and levels of governance
- sends a clear signal to national and international partners

Anchoring digital security in the Constitution does not lock in technical solutions. It stabilizes the principles within which those solutions can evolve.

5. Proposal for a New Constitutional Article: Art. 57a – Digital Security

[1] The Confederation determines the security rules for all public and private actors in Switzerland's digital space and ensures their application.
[2] It protects its data and digital infrastructure and provides subsidiary support to operators of critical infrastructures.
[3] It guarantees the protection of personal data and the digital integrity of individuals.
[4] It guarantees that the digital and informational infrastructure, services and resources essential to the State, the economy and society remain, under all circumstances, independent from any influence contrary to its interests.
[5] It encourages the development of data literacy and digital skills within society.

[6] In coordination with academic and economic actors, it takes measures to anticipate risks and opportunities, thereby maintaining Switzerland among the most advanced and secure nations in the digital domain.

6. What Does Being a Member of the Initiative Committee Involve?

In accordance with federal law, the initiative committee is composed of 7 to 27 members. A balanced representation of cantons and linguistic regions is sought, reflecting the national character of the initiative.

Being a member of the initiative committee:
- entails no operational responsibilities
- involves no financial commitment
- does not require partisan political engagement or mandatory media exposure

Committee members support the initiative in principle.
Those who wish to contribute further — for example on logistical, legal, or public-debate matters — are nevertheless welcome to do so.

7. The Popular Initiative Process: Practical Timeline

Like all federal popular initiatives, this proposal follows a clear, transparent, and well-established democratic process, ensuring that any constitutional amendment rests on a dual legitimacy: that of the people and that of the cantons.

The initiative therefore follows a clearly defined democratic process.

Preparation Phase
- formation of an initiative committee
- finalization of the constitutional amendment
- formal review by the Federal Chancellery
- official publication in the Federal Gazette, enabling the collection of signatures

Signature Collection Phase
- collection of at least 100,000 valid signatures
- maximum fixed duration of 18 months
- certification of signatures by local authorities

Submission and Validation
- submission of all signatures in a single filing
- formal verification and counting
- official confirmation of the initiative's success

Federal Review

- the Federal Council issues a formal opinion and may propose a counterproposal
- Parliament deliberates following the Federal Council's position

Popular Vote

- national vote requiring a double majority of the people and the cantons

8. Conclusion

The popular initiative "For the Digital Security of Switzerland" seeks to grant the Confederation clear constitutional authority to ensure Switzerland's digital security and digital sovereignty. This is a fundamental issue for the country's independence and for the protection of its citizens in an era of accelerating digital transformation.

The initiative does not seek to control, regulate, or centralize the digital domain. Its purpose is to clarify the State's core responsibilities in a field that has become essential to collective life.

Swiss citizens must have the right to live in a digitally secure and sovereign country, where their individual and collective interests are protected.

For the initiative committee in formation, Massimo Rodella, Geneva – 08.03.2026
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Federal Popular Initiative “For the Digital Security of Switzerland”

Schweizerische Eidgenossenschaft
Confédération suisse
Confederazione Svizzera
Confederaziun svizra

Bundeskanzlei BK

Sektion Politische Rechte

Liste der Urheberinnen und Urheber der Volksinitiative
Liste des auteures et des auteurs de l'initiative populaire
Lista delle autrici e degli autori dell'iniziativa popolare

Eidgenössische Volksinitiative «

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Initiative populaire fédérale «

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Iniziativa popolare federale «

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Die unterzeichnenden Urheber und/oder Urheberinnen der Volksinitiative bestätigen der Bundeskanzlei durch ihre eigenhändige Unterschrift, Mitglieder des Initiativkomitees sein zu wollen und zur Kenntnis genommen zu haben, dass sie

1. damit ausschliesslich den Kreis der Rückzugsberechtigten bilden;
2. im Bundesblatt mit Name und Adresse als Urheber bzw. Urheberinnen der Initiative veröffentlicht werden;
3. auf jeder Unterschriftenliste mit Name und Adresse als Rückzugsberechtigte vermerkt sein müssen;
4. sich nach Leistung der Unterschrift nicht mehr aus dem Initiativkomitee zurückziehen können (vgl. Art. 68, 69 und 73 des Bundesgesetzes vom 17. Dezember 1976 über die politischen Rechte; Art. 23 der Verordnung vom 24. Mai 1978 über die politischen Rechte).

Les soussignés ou soussignées auteurs de l'initiative populaire certifient à la Chancellerie fédérale, par leur signature manuscrite, vouloir devenir membres du comité d'initiative et d'avoir pris connaissance du fait:

1. qu'ils ou elles forment ainsi de manière exclusive le cercle des auteurs habilités ou habilitées à retirer l'initiative;
2. qu'en tant qu'auteurs de l'initiative, leur nom et adresse seront publiés dans la Feuille fédérale;
3. qu'en qualité de personnes habilitées à retirer l'initiative, leur nom et adresse doivent figurer sur chaque liste de signatures;
4. qu'ils ou elles ne peuvent plus se retirer du comité d'initiative après avoir apposé leur signature (cf. art. 68, 69 et 73 de la loi fédérale du 17 décembre 1976 sur les droits politiques; art. 23 de l'ordonnance du 24 mai 1978 sur les droits politiques).

Le persone sottoscritte, promotrici dell'iniziativa, certificano alla Cancelleria federale, firmando di proprio pugno, di voler diventare membri del comitato promotore e di aver preso nota che:

1. costituiscono la cerchia esclusiva delle persone autorizzate a ritirare l'iniziativa;
2. in quanto tali, il loro nome e indirizzo saranno pubblicati nel Foglio federale;
3. come persone autorizzate a ritirare l'iniziativa, il loro nome e indirizzo devono essere indicati su ogni lista delle firme;
4. non possono più ritirarsi dal comitato promotore dopo aver apposto la firma (cfr. art. 68, 69 e 73 della legge federale del 17 dicembre 1976 sui diritti politici; art. 23 dell'ordinanza del 24 maggio 1978 sui diritti politici).

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